I. Research Plan

Name of the Research

The Impact of Social Media on Communication Among Students

●Scope of the Research

The research focuses on how social media affects communication, learning, and relationships among students aged 16–25.

●Target Audience

Students,Educators and facilitators,Educational institutions

●Ressearch Methodology

Questionnaires/surveys

Interviews with students

Review of books, journals, and internet sources

●Research Schedule

Activity	Time. Frame
Select topic	week 1
Collect information	Week 2
Conduct surveys/interviews	Week 3
Analyze data.	Week 4
Compile report.	Week 5
Submit report	week 6

●Budget

Item	Cost
Printing questionnaires	R100
Internet/Data	R150
Stationery	R50
Transport	R100
Total	R40

II. Research Report

Title

The Impact of Social Media on Communication Among Students

1. Research Background

Social media platforms such as Facebook, WhatsApp, Instagram, TikTok, and X (Twitter) have transformed the way students communicate. These platforms provide instant communication, information sharing, and opportunities for collaboration. However, excessive use may affect face-to-face communication and academic performance.

2. Data Collection Tools and Techniques Used

The following methods were used:

Questionnaires distributed to 20 students

Informal interviews with 5 students

Secondary research from textbooks, articles, and websites

3. Data Processing

Responses from questionnaires were grouped and counted. Similar responses were categorized together and percentages were calculated for easier interpretation.

4. Data Analysis and Presentation of Results

Survey Results (20 Students)

Question	Yes	No
Use social media daily?	18	2
Helps communication with classmates?	17	3
Helps share learning materials?	16	4
Causes distraction during study?	14	6

Analysis

90% of students use social media daily.

85% believe social media improves communication with classmates.

80% use social media to share educational resources.

70% indicated that social media can be distracting during study time.

●Findings

°Positive Effects

Faster communication.

Easy sharing of information and study materials.

Improved collaboration on group assignments.

Access to educational content.

°Negative Effects

Distraction from studies.

Reduced face-to-face interaction.

Potential misuse and cyberbullying.

Time management challenges.

5. Recommendations and Conclusions

●Recommendations

1. Students should use social media responsibly.

2. Study groups should utilize educational platforms for learning

3. Institutions should educate students about digital citizenship.

4. Time management strategies should be encouraged.

●Conclusion

The research found that social media has a significant impact on student communication. It improves communication, collaboration, and access to information. However, excessive use may negatively affect academic performance and personal interaction. Students should therefore balance social media use with their educational responsibilities.

■References

Brink, . (2012). Professional Communication. 3rd ed. London: Longman.

Communication textbooks and study guides.

Educational websites and journal articles on social media and communication.